effect appearing to glance back out and across the frame, over the top of Freed's head. The other two soldiers face the opposing phalanx, their backs and helmets facing the camera. Freed's proximity to these men suggests that he was standing directly behind the soldiers, as if to shield himself from enemy fire or advancement, as he remains extremely close to a front line of division. In this case, there is no obviously significant, imposed distance between Freed and the soldiers. It appears that the photographer is enclosed, just not by the Wall.

Similarly, in another image capturing a soldier eating lunch on the curb (fig. 1.7), no material components of the border system are present within the frame. Instead, an American soldier in glasses, his combat helmet shifted sideways, sits cross-legged on the curb outside a famous Zimmerstrasse *Apotheke* (pharmacy) as the central focus of the image. Freed stands several feet from the GI, hovering above him while he eats from a tray of fast food, his rifle lying on the ground beside him. Civilians chat above and around the soldier, while the presence of the Wall, less than twenty feet from the curb, is almost entirely left out of the frame. Another soldier, seated by the corner pharmacy, is barely visible. The only evidence of his presence is a black combat boot protruding from a crowd of people standing above and in front of him. Freed photographs in close proximity to the subjects but calibrates a middle distance by locating intermediate figures between them. Here again Freed locates himself in a spatial relationship that triangulates his viewpoint in relation to the American troops and the Berlin Wall. By staging his photograph from an oblique street angle and a short distance from lunching soldiers, he produces an image that reads as if he were in transit, wandering to or through the scene, rather than being a fixture along the Wall. In these images, the Berlin Wall is only a subtext, a border constituted by military might and a flurry of confused visual encounters. Freed offers no singular vision of this moment of the Berlin Crisis but instead indexes uncertainty and the flurry of activity summoned by the construction of a closed border.